

to be processed, highlighting the potential for investment in pulp, concentrates, juices, frozen foods, dehydration, grading, packaging and branded products.

Geography further strengthens the proposition. The state's ports at Visakhapatnam, Gangavaram and Krishnapatnam provide export gateways, while industrial corridors connect agricultural regions to major consumption centres such as Bengaluru, Chennai and Hyderabad.

A NETWORK OF SPECIALISED FOOD BELTS

Rather than relying on a single food-processing hub, Andhra Pradesh is developing a series of specialised regional ecosystems.

The Godavari aqua and plantation belt, covering West Godavari, Eluru, East Godavari, Kakinada and Konaseema, combines shrimp and fish production with paddy, coconut, cocoa, banana, oil palm, poultry and dairy. The opportunity lies in moving beyond commodity exports towards processed seafood, marine ingredients, cocoa products, coconut derivatives, edible oils and feed manufacturing.

The Krishna-Guntur agro and spice belt brings together chilli, turmeric, paddy, maize, pulses, dairy, poultry and aquaculture. Supported by a well-developed trading ecosystem, the region is suited for spice sterilisation, oleoresins, blended spices, rice derivatives and ready-to-eat food products.

The Chittoor-Annamayya horticulture belt offers another distinct proposition. Mango, tomato, papaya, banana and pomegranate production creates opportunities in pulp, juices,



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concentrates, IQF products and dehydration. Existing infrastructure, including the Srini Mega Food Park, provides a foundation for further expansion.

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North Coastal Andhra combines seafood, cashew, coconut, paddy and millets with strong port connectivity, while tribal districts such as Alluri Sitharama Raju and Parvathipuram Manyam offer opportunities in coffee, turmeric, honey, millets, tamarind and other forest-based products.

INFRASTRUCTURE BETWEEN FARM AND FACTORY

The state's processing ambitions are supported by a growing post-harvest infrastructure network.

Andhra Pradesh has 363 cold-storage facilities with capacity exceeding 1.6 million MT, along with hundreds of warehouses, ripening chambers and more than 4,500 pack houses. Primary processing centres, testing laboratories, cold-chain infrastructure and waste-treatment facilities add to the ecosystem.

The next phase centres on food parks. Under Food Processing Policy 4.0, the state has proposed 77 MSME food parks, 26 large food parks and 175 nano food parks, along with four food-export hubs and an animal-feed park.

The objective is straightforward: provide common infrastructure closer to producers, reduce logistics costs and enable enterprises to establish operations without building every facility independently.

Existing projects illustrate the model. The Srini Mega Food Park in Chittoor supports horticulture and multi-product processing through pulping, IQF, bottling, packaging, cold storage and testing facilities. The Godavari Mega Aqua Food Park in West Godavari focuses on fish and shrimp processing, supported by pre-processing, freezing, cold storage, ice-making and testing infrastructure.

The challenge now is ensuring that planned facilities evolve into fully functioning industrial ecosystems with occupied plots, reliable utilities, shared services and market connectivity.

FROM COMMODITIES TO VALUE-ADDED EXPORTS

The strategic opportunity for Andhra Pradesh is not simply producing more food but capturing a larger share of the value created between farm and consumer.

That means converting shrimp into ready-to-cook and ready-to-eat products; fruits into concentrates, beverages and ingredients; chilli into sterilised spices and oleoresins; groundnut into specialised ingredients; milk into high-value dairy products; and millets into branded health foods.

Such diversification can also reduce dependence on volatile commodity markets. Value-added products, brands and specialised ingredients are generally less exposed to fluctuations in global commodity prices and trade conditions.

Quality and traceability will be critical. International markets increasingly require strict compliance on food safety, residues, sourcing and product tracking. Investments in accredited laboratories, testing facilities, digital traceability systems, irradiation infrastructure and modern cold chains can therefore become competitive advantages rather than regulatory requirements.

A POLICY FRAMEWORK FOR GROWTH

The sector is supported by both central and state-level programmes.

National schemes such as Pradhan Mantri Kisan